Nullah Junction with one section of ten men under the command of Naib Subedar Kanhya Lal, further reinforced by the Patrol Base troops, continued to hold the Chinese at bay throughout 22 October, thereby preventing them from spilling out into the Changchenmo Valley and threatening Hot Springs. The Chinese continued to fire at Nullah Junction but did not put in any determined infantry attack. Though casualties continued to mount—the section commander had his legs blown off from under him—and communication with Hot Springs had been cut, the Indians hung on gamely. Two men were then sent to Hot Springs to ask for further orders.

By 23 October, almost all the men who had survived the initial Chinese onslaught in the Northern Sector and in the Galwan Valley, were on the move, trying as best as they could to fall back on Nullah Junction and then on to Hot Springs. However, there were a few exceptions. Skalzang Dorge, a Ladakhi serving with 14 J&K Militia had been wounded at DBO. Somehow, as the rest of the Indian troops pulled out, Dorge was left behind. Finding himself abandoned, the militiaman crawled into a bunker, dressed his own wounds and settled down to wait, firm in the belief that his comrades would return soon. Living off dry rations and burning kerosene to keep warm, Dorge stayed alive through the next six months until he was rescued in April 1963. With the Chinese also staying clear, Dorge ensured that DBO remained in Indian hands.

The Kongka incident of 1959 had adversely affected public opinion against the Chinese, so much so that even pro-Chinese Marxist parties within India had reacted negatively. To placate public opinion, the Chinese had acknowledged that the Hot Springs area was indeed Indian territory. At the same time they had also declared that Kongka-la and the Lanak-la were Chinese territory. By clearing the Galwan Basin of Indian troops and having occupied the western slopes of the Karakorams, the Chinese forces decided to tailor their objectives in the Hot Springs region accordingly. They therefore decided to leave the middle and lower portions of the Changchenmo Valley in Indian hands while securing Kongka-la and the upper portion of the Changchenmo Valley. This also meant that the Chinese could declare they did not cross their 1959 claim line in the region.

Major Ajit Singh was the commanding officer at Hot Springs. On the morning of 23 October, the situation was extremely critical. Nullah Junction was not only valiantly holding out, it was acting as a block, preventing the